# Customer Meeting 1 – Escape the Geese

## Meeting details

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| Date | 9 October 2026 |
| Location | Meeting room (CSE/015) |
| Attendees | Customer: Konstas Barmpis ; Team Members: Louis Price, Sruthiksha Ananth, Sarah James, Tim Giles, Henrik Bowden, June Njiro |
| Purpose | Clarify the product brief, especially quality requirements, gameplay rules and accessibility |

The customer confirmed a non-violent, top-down 2D desktop game in which the player disperses waves of geese within a time limit. Answers below are summarised from the meeting recording and the team's notes.

## Questions and answers

### Platform and presentation

**Q1. What hardware should this run on, and should it run on mobile devices?** Standard desktop computers running the main operating systems (Windows, macOS and Linux). The game must run correctly full screen on an average desktop monitor. Mobile is not needed for this first version.

**Q2. Should the product be 2D or 3D?** 2D, using a top-down view. Players are familiar with 2D in this genre, and it is feasible within the project timeline.

**Q3. Should the colour scheme match real life or be exaggerated to help the player?** No colour requirement for the map, which is a background rather than an obstacle. The game uses a single map with no map changes, and its layout should resemble the campus. Buildings can be interactables (for example, a Piazza building that gives food), but players do not enter them. Anything the player interacts with must stand out without relying on colour alone, for example by sparkling.

**Q4. Are there any restrictions on engines or libraries beyond appropriate licensing?** The game must be written in Java, as taught at the university. No specific engine is required, but it should be stable, popular, well documented and used for similar 2D games. Existing assets, engines and libraries may be reused if their licences are compatible; licences must be recorded in a document, and assets attributed appropriately.

**Q5. How fast should the game load?** Within a couple of seconds on an average computer or laptop with no dedicated graphics card, since users become annoyed by longer loading times.

## Gameplay, winning and losing

**Q6. Should there be multiple difficulty levels, and how should they differ?** The game should be accessible and completable by most players: easy and encouraging, challenging but not frustrating. Difficulty levels may be added later if feasible, possibly in Assessment 2, but are not required. The team controls difficulty through, for example, goose speed and numbers, wave timing and item design.

**Q7. Should geese be dispersed or eliminated?** Dispersed.

**Q8. What counts as dispersing enough geese?** The game is non-violent and must not show a health bar. Mechanically it works like health, but is presented as the player's tiredness or annoyance; when this fills, the player gives up and returns to their room. The team chooses the setting (realistic, cartoon or fantasy) and how geese are dispersed, but the story of being bullied by geese must be consistent, immersive and non-violent. It must clearly evoke the University of York, for example through building or module names, without overdoing it.

**Q9. If the 5-minute timer ends before the player finishes, is that a loss or a low score?** The 5-minute timer is the loss condition. Players who manage the waves efficiently can finish early, so they do not get bored; a short countdown between waves (for example, 10 seconds) is one common approach. If the geese have not been dispersed when the timer ends, the player loses and the character runs back to their room exhausted. Hiding in a sanctuary does not prevent a loss. An alternative win, such as escaping the geese, is allowed only as a rare, hard-to-find edge case; if one exists, distractions must not make escaping easy.

**Q10. Can the game end before 5 minutes if there are too many geese?** Yes. The player retreats to shelter or the starting point from exhaustion.

## Items and events

**Q11. How can the player disperse the geese? Are specific items needed?** Items should suit the setting. In a realistic world this would be food, spread with a small amount of physics, with geese dispersing in response. For example, breadcrumbs could affect an area, while a single piece of chocolate lands in one spot. Events could introduce different scenarios, such as pirates or space.

**Q12. What does using items "smartly" mean?** It means the player has agency: once they understand what an item does, they choose how to use it. Items should vary, for example in strength, range, number of geese affected, and whether they are aimed at or away from a goose. For example, throwing a pebble away from a goose distracts it, but throwing it at the goose may enrage it and make it faster.

**Q13. Which campus features must be included? Should any link to events, such as by a lake?** Similar infrastructure, with a layout designed to resemble the campus, including landmarks. Controls and interactions should follow the conventions of similar games, so players already know how to play.

**Additional point from the customer:** events are environmental triggers that work like item effects but are usually more impactful. They should be interesting, and can add or remove items to help or hinder the player.

### Accessibility

**Q14. Are there accessibility requirements, such as control remapping, colour-blind friendly visuals or subtitles for audio cues?** The game must be accessible to everyone. Events must be obvious through both sound and visuals, showing their causes and effects. For example, a duck that bites turns red, with a sound and a "quack" speech bubble, which helps colour-blind players. Any important information must use at least two of sound, visuals and text. A pause option, volume control and full screen (by default or through a settings menu) are expected; no other settings are needed.

### Scope and saving

**Q15. Should there be a leaderboard or saved high scores, and how should scores be weighted?** No. The game is single-player and nothing is saved: no progression, player data or scores.

**Additional point from the customer:** the game is promotional, a quick, relaxed mini-game. Progress is not saved, and replayability is mostly optional. Players escape from waves of geese; whether waves are continuous or one after another is the team's choice, as long as the timing is lenient. Players should be able to run the game with no configuration.

### Project process

**Q16. How often would you like to review progress (demos, builds or documents)?** Set meetings, working incrementally from a basic playable version and revisiting requirements at each stage, with feedback from a user testing group. The customer is available in the labs. The game must be easy to extend as requirements change. It must also include a tutorial for players: a screen showing the controls, or a short self-playing demo.

## Outcomes

The meeting confirmed the platform, view and non-violent premise, and defined how the game is won and lost. Each agreed point maps to the requirements below.

| Agreed point | Question | Requirement IDs |
|---|---|---|
| Runs on Windows, macOS and Linux desktops, including full screen; no mobile | Q1 | CR_PLATFORM, CR_HARDWARE |
| Top-down 2D view | Q2 | CR_VIEW |
| Written in Java, using a stable, well-documented engine | Q4 | CR_JAVA |
| Compatible licences recorded and assets attributed | Q4 | CR_LICENCE |
| Loads within a couple of seconds on an average computer | Q5 | QR_STARTUP |
| Single map resembling campus, with clear York references | Q3, Q8, Q13 | UR_RELATE, FR_LANDMARKS |
| Interactables (e.g. buildings) stand out without relying on colour | Q3 | FR_INTERACTABLES |
| Controls follow genre conventions | Q13 | FR_MOVE_KEYS |
| Non-violent; no health bar, tiredness or annoyance meter instead | Q7, Q8 | CR_PEACE, FR_EXHAUSTION_METER |
| Geese arrive in waves with lenient timing | Additional point | UR_GEESE, FR_GEESE_WAVES |

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| Player can finish early by clearing the waves | Q9 | FR_WIN |
| Lose when the 5-minute timer ends or the meter fills | Q9, Q10 | FR_TIMER, FR_LOSE |
| Escape win only as a rare edge case | Q9 | FR_ESCAPE_WIN (May) |
| Items suit the setting and vary in strength, range and targets | Q11, Q12 | UR_ITEMS, FR_ITEM_DISPERSE, FR_ITEM_TYPES |
| Misusing an item can enrage geese | Q12 | FR_ITEM_MISUSE |
| Events add or remove items and act like stronger item effects | Additional point | UR_EVENTS, FR_EVENT_ITEMS |
| Important information uses at least two of sound, visuals and text | Q14 | UR_ACCESSIBILITY, FR_EVENT_AUDIO, FR_EVENT_VISUAL |
| Pause, volume control and full screen | Q14 | FR_PAUSE, FR_VOLUME, FR_FULLSCREEN |
| Tutorial screen or self-playing demo | Q16 | FR_TUTORIAL |
| Easy and accessible for most players | Q6 | UR_ACCESSIBILITY, QR_WINNABILITY |
| Difficulty levels optional, possibly in Assessment 2 | Q6 | FR_DIFFICULTY (May) |

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| Easy to extend between iterations | Q16 | QR_EXTENSIBILITY |
| No saving, leaderboard or player data | Q15 | Out of scope |